

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Pentecost 11

16 August 2026

Preaching:

STRIPS OF PAPER IN PROGRAM FOR PRAYERS

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Laura and Ianthe to center chancel, Lulu and Garfield to lectern]

Welcome

Words of Gathering

***Hymn of Gathering**

[Choir processes during the hymn into their central spot on the chancel. Emily to lectern during the final line of hymn]

***Prayer of Awareness**
Amen and Amen!

[Emily joins the choir]

***Introit**

[Juniper to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

Our Holy Scriptures tell us that we are all created in the image and likeness of God. In this place, we celebrate the Mystery of who God is. We remember that our tradition is rich in calling The Divine by many names: Holy One, Loving Mother, Compassionate Father, Source of Life, Redeemer, Loving Presence, and El-Roi, the God who sees.

Because of this Mystery, we invite you to pray The Lord's Prayer in your own tradition and language. In this way, we celebrate the interconnectedness of our lives, whether we come from near or from far. Let us now pray together as Jesus taught us...

*Our [God], who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy Name,
thy kingdom come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our debts,
as we forgive our debtors.
And lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kingdom,
and the power, and the glory,
forever.
Amen.*

[All turn towards altar except for Max and William who go to the lectern]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Max and William already at lectern]

***Passing of the Peace**

Please be seated

[Youth all go sit on the lectern side. Esme to lectern]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition

For this witness of the ancients...
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph short transition Ianthe to lectern]

Prayers with the People

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Silence

[Christoph transition out of silence while David and Brandon place two stands and two chairs center chancel. Once set, Esme and Lulu go to places, Christoph stops, and they begin]

Music for Reflection

[Emily and Ianthe to lectern, Esme and Lulu stay in center]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Christoph transition for choir. David and Ianthe remove the chairs and stands. Choir comes into their spot for THIS IS ME]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition LVF to pulpit, choir to seats]

Sermon

[Christoph transition William and Ivan to lectern, and the choir gets into place]

Invitation to Generosity

Offertory Anthem

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Max and Alizar to lectern toward end of doxology]

***Offering Prayer**

Amen and Amen.

Alizar: *Please be seated*

[Laura center chancel. ALL YOUTH stay central with the choir for choral response, and Garfield and Emily go to the lectern]

Life at First Church

[Garfield and Emily already at the lectern]

Words of Blessing

Choral Response

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Laura center chancel]

Postlude

Inside The Music